Mid-Point Reflective Learning Journal

Jardine Engineering Corporation, Hong Kong

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Placement Overview and Learning Objectives

Company: Jardine Engineering Corporation, Hong Kong

Job Title: Student Trainee

Supervisor: Mr. Fong, Senior Manager

Mentor: Mr. Roger, Senior Engineer

At the outset of this placement, I set four learning objectives using the What/Why/How framework:

- Produce accurate, professional engineering drawings in AutoCAD for systems such as monorail tracks and BMU components.
- Develop the ability to write and edit clear engineering method statements and technical documentation.
- Build proficiency in Microsoft Project for tracking and scheduling engineering tasks.
- Improve professional communication in preparing quotations and coordinating with suppliers and stakeholders.

Journal Entries

Week 1 – May 11 to May 15, 2026

Focused on early monorail and BMU track drawings, including revisions, quantity counting, and tolerance additions. Began the PWH method statement and added grouting details to CAD files.

Week 2 – May 18 to May 22, 2026

Shifted into quotation work, preparing and checking quotations for Buildings 8, 9, and 11, and the HKU TL3 project, along with several material quotations and submissions. Completed a base plate fixing revision and captured demonstration photos for the monorail installation.

Week 3 – May 26 to May 29, 2026 (two sick days)

Edited the NDH PowerPoint presentation, updated monorail CAD drawings following new engineering calculations, and began organizing gondola usage records.

Week 4 – June 1 to June 5, 2026

Focused on material submissions and invoicing, including a GH invoice, an updated gondola usage record, and several material submission revisions. Completed design calculation and remedial proposal updates, and started drafting the BMU method statement.

Week 5 – June 8 to June 12, 2026

Completed plotting of monorail components and finalized the PWH Monorail Method Statement. Submitted tender documents at Sheung Wan and began the BMU End Stop and Jig CAD drawings.

Week 6 – June 15 to June 19, 2026

Continued the O&M Manual for GH, added catalog details to the design calculation, and submitted a second round of tender documents at Wan Chai. Visited AECOM in person to coordinate on project communication.

Week 7 – June 22 to June 26, 2026

Began assisting on-site at the PWH construction site in addition to drawing work, including checking pipe interference with the monorail and completing detailed BMU track drawings. Finalized the GH O&M Manual.

Week 8 – June 29 to July 3, 2026

Completed the Lomond Road O&M Manual, a survey report, and a remedial proposal for the monorail, and visited the Buildings Department as part of ongoing project coordination.

Mid-Point Reflection

Retell

At the mid-point of this placement, my day-to-day work has shifted from the drafting-heavy tasks of May into a broader mix of design calculations, tender submissions, and on-site support at the PWH construction site. The first few weeks were spent almost entirely on monorail and BMU drawing revisions, but June introduced more responsibility: preparing O&M manuals with less direct oversight, coordinating directly with AECOM, and representing finished work at site visits and government submissions to the Buildings Department. I also took on a larger share of the quotation and material submission process during this stretch, which meant more direct contact with suppliers rather than only internal drafting work, and more accountability for the accuracy of numbers that go out under the company's name rather than just the drawings behind them.

Relate

This is not my first term at Jardine, and that history has shaped how quickly I settled back in. I already knew my coworkers, the software conventions, and the informal norms of the office, which meant the first weeks were about resuming work rather than learning the workplace from scratch. Mayer and Salovey (1997) describe emotional intelligence as the ability to perceive, understand, and reflectively regulate emotion in a way that supports thought and action. That framework is useful here: returning to a familiar team let me manage the emotional adjustment of the placement quickly, freeing attention for the more technical demands of the second month. Goleman's (1995) domain of relationship management, in particular the ability to build rapport and communicate requirements clearly, is also visible in how coordination with AECOM and the PWH site team has gone this month; explaining drawing details to people outside my discipline has required more deliberate, plain-language communication than drafting alone ever did.

My DISC profile, S/CD (Supportive primary, Cautious and Dominant secondary), also maps onto the pattern of work I have gravitated toward. The Supportive trait shows in the low-friction way I picked work back up with the same coworkers, while the Cautious secondary trait shows in the amount of checking and revision built into my routine: BMU track drawings revised multiple times, quotations checked before submission, and design calculations reviewed against catalog data before finalizing. This lines up with Information and Data Management being one of the top three strengths I identified in my competency self-assessment.

Reflect

Beyond the technical work, this placement has also been a personal reflection point. Hong Kong itself feels different from the city I grew up in; the pace of construction and the amount of new development visible during site visits and Buildings Department trips is a noticeable shift from my memory of it. My own perspective has changed as much as the city has. I am no longer just a resident who grew up here; I am returning as an engineering student viewing the same streets and the same industry through a technical lens rather than a personal one. Being trilingual and having grown up locally still gives me an advantage that I did not fully appreciate before this term: I can move between the English-heavy documentation side of the office and the Cantonese-speaking site and vendor conversations without friction, which is not something every co-op student at this company can do.

The engineering industry here has changed as well over the past few years, particularly in how much of the submission and coordination process, tender documents, material submissions, and O&M manuals, has moved toward digital-first workflows. Adjusting to that shift alongside relearning the company has been a good test of adaptability, one of the development areas I flagged in my original self-assessment.

Looking at my four learning objectives, three are progressing well: AutoCAD proficiency continues to grow through repeated drawing revisions, method statement writing has become noticeably faster and cleaner, and professional communication has improved through direct coordination with AECOM and site staff. Microsoft Project is the objective needing the most attention going into the second half of the term, since June's work centered more on drawings, O&M manuals, and site coordination than on active schedule management. Creativity and Innovation and Networking and Relationship Building also remain areas I want to push on deliberately in the coming weeks, since most of my work so far has been execution-focused rather than proposal-driven. For the second half of the placement, I want to look for chances to suggest alternatives on tasks like the remedial proposal work rather than only executing given specifications, and to build direct working relationships with contacts beyond Mr. Fong and Mr. Roger, including the AECOM and site teams I have started working with this month.

References

Goleman, D. (1995). Emotional intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ. Bantam Books.

Mayer, J. D., & Salovey, P. (1997). What is emotional intelligence? In P. Salovey & D. J. Sluyter (Eds.), Emotional development and emotional intelligence: Educational implications (pp. 3–34). Basic Books.